

Office Memorandum • UNITED STATES GOVERNMENT.

TO : Assistant Director, SI

FROM : Chief, Physics & Electronics Division, SI

SUBJECT: Unidentified Flying Objects

DATE: 3 July 1953

000264

1. Reference is made to your memorandum of 27 May 1953, subject as above, which assigned to this Division the responsibility "for maintaining current knowledge of reports of sightings of unidentified flying objects."

2. Since the referenced memorandum did not stipulate the priority of this project versus the normal responsibilities of this Division, nor indicated the depth or scope of required knowledge, the Division has reviewed the status of the project, its present method of handling and its possible timeliness or relationship to the current productive intelligence activities of the Division. The review involved informal discussions with ASD personnel, with Mr. Heckert, JOCI, with USAF personnel and with members of the Scientific Review Board called by CIA last year.

3. The review indicated that a close follow-up of the project including a careful analysis of all incoming information and the corresponding liaison with the sources would require continuous efforts of two analysts, a file clerk and a considerable typing load.

4. In view of the findings of the Board that a close inspection of the available material does not postulate a serious, direct threat to national security, and that no information has been obtained since the Board's conclusion to necessitate their modifications, it was concluded that:

a. the project will be considered as inactive

b. the incoming material will be reviewed periodically to segregate references to recognizable and explainable phenomena from those which come under the definition of "unidentified flying objects"

c. all material on unidentified objects will be deposited in the files for future reference unless it raises an immediately recognizable problem of concern to national security.

5. With the above premise it is planned to handle the project with a part-time use of an analyst and a file clerk. To provide filing facilities, one additional filing cabinet will be requested.

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to
file
[Signature] TODOS M. ODARENKO

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